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# The Architect as Worker

Individual Responsibility  
and Collective Power

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**Professional Practice 1**  
Helen Duong | RMIT Architecture

# Professional

knowledge / judgement / responsibility



OR/AND

# Worker

labour / salary / hours



**FA Failed  
Architecture**

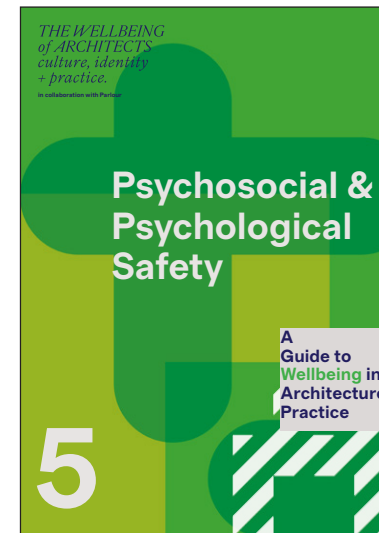
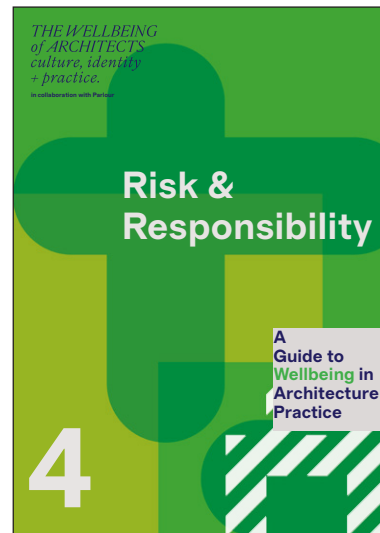
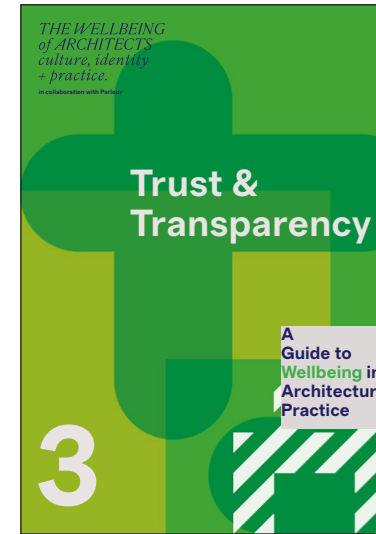
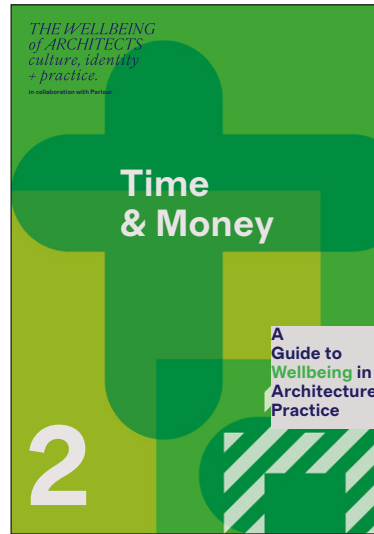
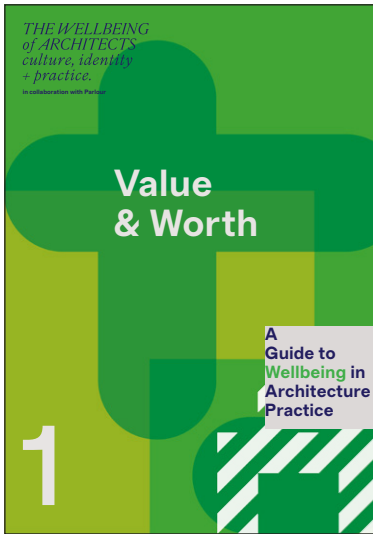
**DO WHAT  
YOU LOVE**

## **Death to the Calling: A Job in Architecture Is Still a Job**

**Marisa Cortright**

**The myth of the calling obscures the role of architectural support staff and encourages architects to surrender their workers' rights. It stands in the way of solidarity between all architectural workers.**

**“A CALLING”**



The Guides to Wellbeing in  
Architecture Practice  
Parlour May 2024

THE GOOD EMPLOYER

PROJECT INFORMATION

Project Name

Project Number

Project Manager

Updated

Fee Development Project

2016000.00

ArchitectBox

September 17, 2016

PROJECT ASSUMPTIONS

Input project size and cost info into white boxes

| Program         | Est. GSF | Est. \$/GSF | Total Est. Cost |
|-----------------|----------|-------------|-----------------|
| Parking Garage  | 100,000  | \$ 100      | \$ 10,000,000   |
| Retail          | 25,000   | \$ 385      | \$ 4,625,000    |
| Office          | 313,500  | \$ 250      | \$ 81,375,000   |
| Site Work       | 25,000   | \$ 80       | \$ 2,000,000    |
|                 |          |             | \$ -            |
|                 |          |             | \$ -            |
| Project Totals: | 483,500  | \$ 207      | \$ 100,000,000  |

ARCHITECT FEE DEVELOPMENT

Input percentages in white boxes to develop fee

|                                                                      |        |              |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|--------------|
| Total A/E Design Fee:                                                | 6.00%  | \$ 6,000,000 |
| Design fee that the client pays as a percentage of construction cost |        |              |
| Architect Share of Total Design Fee:                                 | 60.00% | \$ 3,600,000 |
| Contingency:                                                         | 10.00% | \$ (360,000) |
| Non-Reimbursable Expenses:                                           | 2.50%  | \$ (90,000)  |
| Other Architect Costs:                                               |        |              |
| Net Architecture Fee:                                                |        | \$ 3,150,000 |
| Architect's budget for labor hours                                   |        |              |

CONSULTANT FEE DEVELOPMENT

Input percentages in white boxes to develop fee

|                                                                                     |      |                   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|-------------------|
| Consultant Fee Goal:                                                                | 40%  | \$ 2,400,000      |
| Based on Total Design Fee minus the Architect's Share                               |      |                   |
| Consultant Contingency:                                                             | 2.0% | \$ (48,000)       |
| Consultant Total:                                                                   |      | \$ 2,352,000      |
| Variance:                                                                           |      | \$ (298,000) 0.0% |
| If negative, reduce Architect's Share of Total Design Fee or Reduce Consultant Fees |      |                   |

BASIC SERVICES ANALYSIS

Allows a review of Basic Services as opposed to the entire fee

|                                                         |              |
|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Architecture Fee:                                       | \$ 3,600,000 |
| Basic Services Consultants Fee:                         | \$ 1,687,500 |
| Select Basic Services in Consultant Fees table at right |              |
| Total Basic Services Fee:                               | \$ 5,287,500 |
| Total Basic Services Fee per Bldg GSF:                  | \$10.94      |
| Basic Services as % of Construction Cost:               | 5.29%        |

COMMON METRICS

Lower metrics to help analyze the proposed fee

|                                                          |         |
|----------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Total A/E Fee per Bldg GSF:                              | \$12.41 |
| Net Arch Fee per Bldg GSF:                               | \$6.51  |
| Architecture Fee Percentage of Construction:             | 3.60%   |
| Consultants Fee Percentage of Construction:              | 2.35%   |
| Total A/E Basic Services Fee Percentage of Construction: | 5.29%   |
| Architecture Labor Hours per 100 GSF of Building:        | 3.99    |

ARCHITECT'S NOTES

EXAMPLE DATA

The example data here is for a large project. Architects should keep a list of projects with the final fee spending at completion to help analyze the fee based on the common metrics. We provide Basic Services metrics since they are often used to compare different proposals among architects. This analysis is optional. Note that the Variance box under CONSULTANT FEE DEVELOPMENT is red since the consultant fees exceed the goal. In this case, the architect must lower the consultant contingency, lower the architect's share of fee, or negot a lower fee with the consultants.

ARCHITECT LABOR DEVELOPMENT

Input phase percentages, rates, and number of weeks per phase in white boxes to analyze available FTEs for labor

| Phase              | Percent | Total Fee    | Net Arch Fee | Avg Rate | Hours  | Weeks | FTEs |
|--------------------|---------|--------------|--------------|----------|--------|-------|------|
| Pre Design         |         | \$ -         | \$ -         |          |        |       |      |
| Schematic Design   | 15%     | \$ 900,000   | \$ 472,500   | \$ 360   | 2,864  | 12    | 5.97 |
| Design Development | 20%     | \$ 1,200,000 | \$ 630,000   | \$ 365   | 3,818  | 14    | 6.82 |
| Construction Docs  | 40%     | \$ 2,400,000 | \$ 1,260,000 | \$ 355   | 8,129  | 24    | 8.47 |
| Bidding            | 5%      | \$ 300,000   | \$ 157,500   | \$ 375   | 900    | 8     | 2.81 |
| Construction Admin | 20%     | \$ 1,200,000 | \$ 630,000   | \$ 375   | 3,600  | 26    | 3.46 |
| Project Totals     | 100%    | \$ 6,000,000 | \$ 3,150,000 |          | 19,311 | 84    | 5.75 |

CONSULTANT FEES

Input fees from consultant proposals

| Consultant            | Firm Name | Fee          | Basic Services? | % of Total Fee | % of Const Cost |
|-----------------------|-----------|--------------|-----------------|----------------|-----------------|
| Structural            |           | \$ 675,000   | x               | 11.3%          | 0.7%            |
| Mechanical            |           | \$ 355,000   | x               | 5.9%           | 0.4%            |
| Electrical            |           | \$ 350,000   | x               | 5.8%           | 0.4%            |
| Itch / Data / IT      |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
| Plumbing              |           | \$ 250,000   | x               | 4.2%           | 0.3%            |
| Code                  |           | \$ 10,000    | x               | 0.2%           | 0.0%            |
| Accessibility / ADA   |           | \$ 5,500     | x               | 0.1%           | 0.0%            |
| Acoustics / Vibration |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
| Art                   |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
| Audio/Visual          |           | \$ 75,000    |                 | 1.3%           | 0.1%            |
| Civil                 |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
| Commissioning         |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
| Cost Estimate         |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
| Door Hardware         |           | \$ 10,000    | x               | 0.2%           | 0.0%            |
| Elevators             |           | \$ 32,000    | x               | 0.5%           | 0.0%            |
| Enclosure             |           | \$ 125,000   |                 | 2.1%           | 0.1%            |
| Energy Modeling       |           | \$ 40,000    |                 | 0.7%           | 0.0%            |
| Food Services         |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
| Furniture             |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
| Geotechnical          |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
| HeatMat               |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
| Landscape             |           | \$ 100,000   |                 | 1.7%           | 0.1%            |
| LEED/Sustainable      |           | \$ 50,000    |                 | 0.8%           | 0.1%            |
| Lighting              |           | \$ 90,000    |                 | 1.5%           | 0.1%            |
| Security              |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
| Signage / Wayfinding  |           | \$ 100,000   |                 | 1.7%           | 0.1%            |
| Traffic / Parking     |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
| Wind                  |           | \$ 85,000    |                 | 1.4%           | 0.1%            |
|                       |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
|                       |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
|                       |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
|                       |           | \$ -         |                 |                |                 |
| Consultant Totals:    |           | \$ 2,352,500 |                 | 39.21%         | 2.95%           |

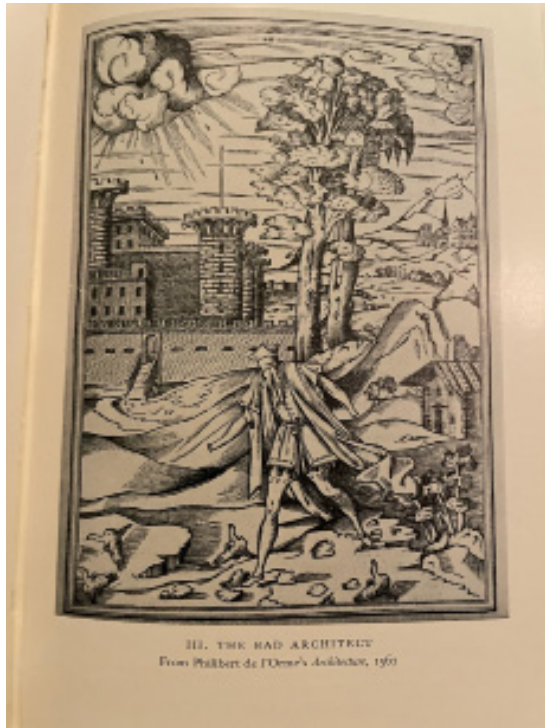


Architectural fee proposal /  
timesheet / resourcing spreadsheet  
/ project programme

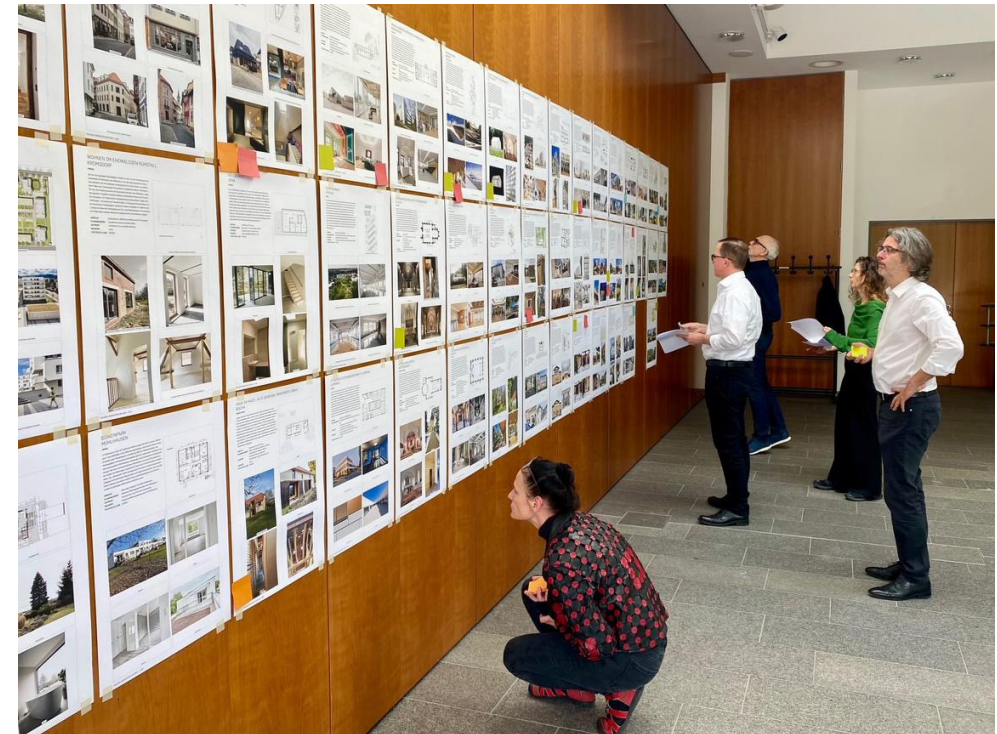
LABOUR

LOW FEE → LOW TIME



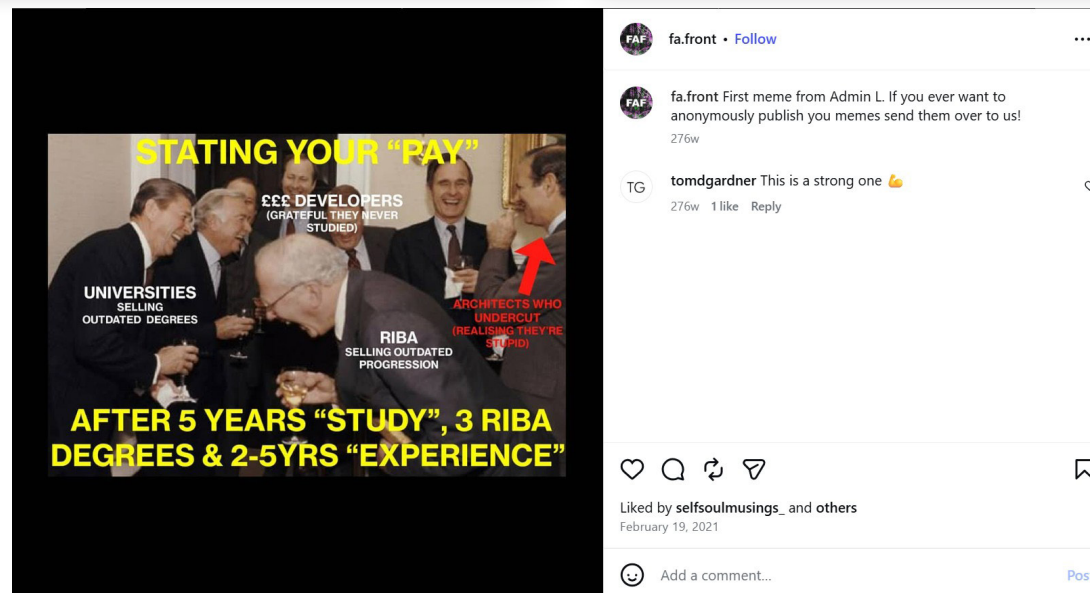
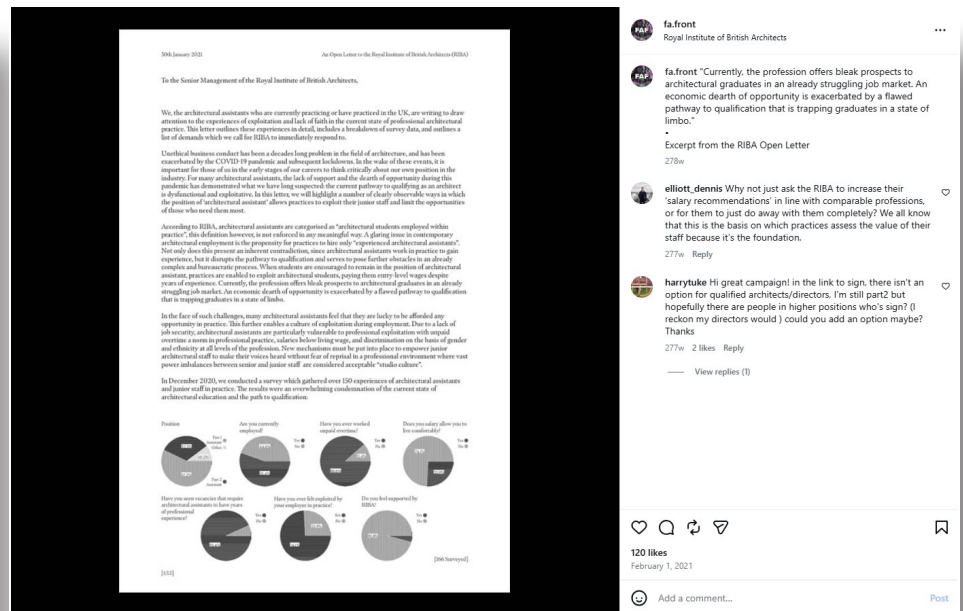
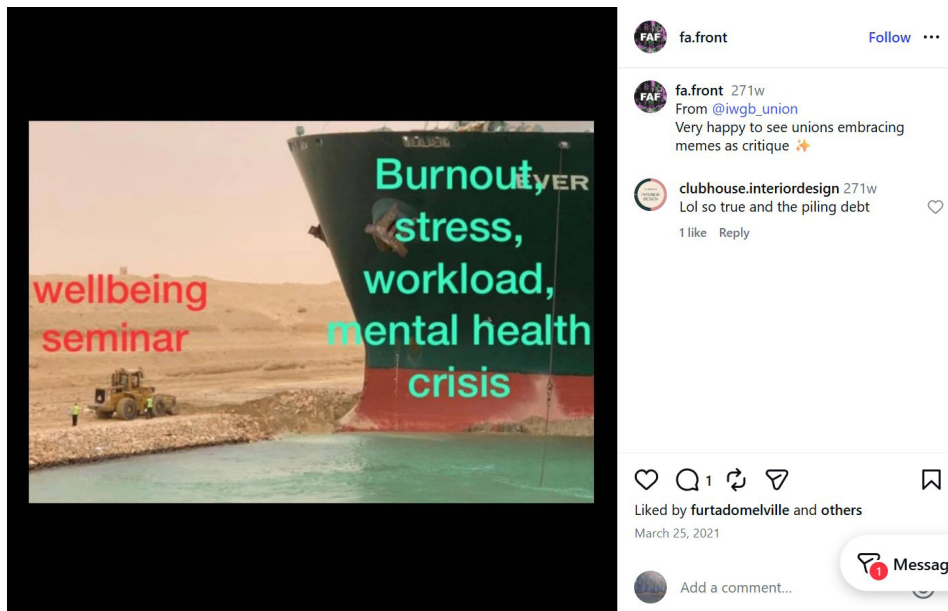


De L'Orme's Good and Bad Architect



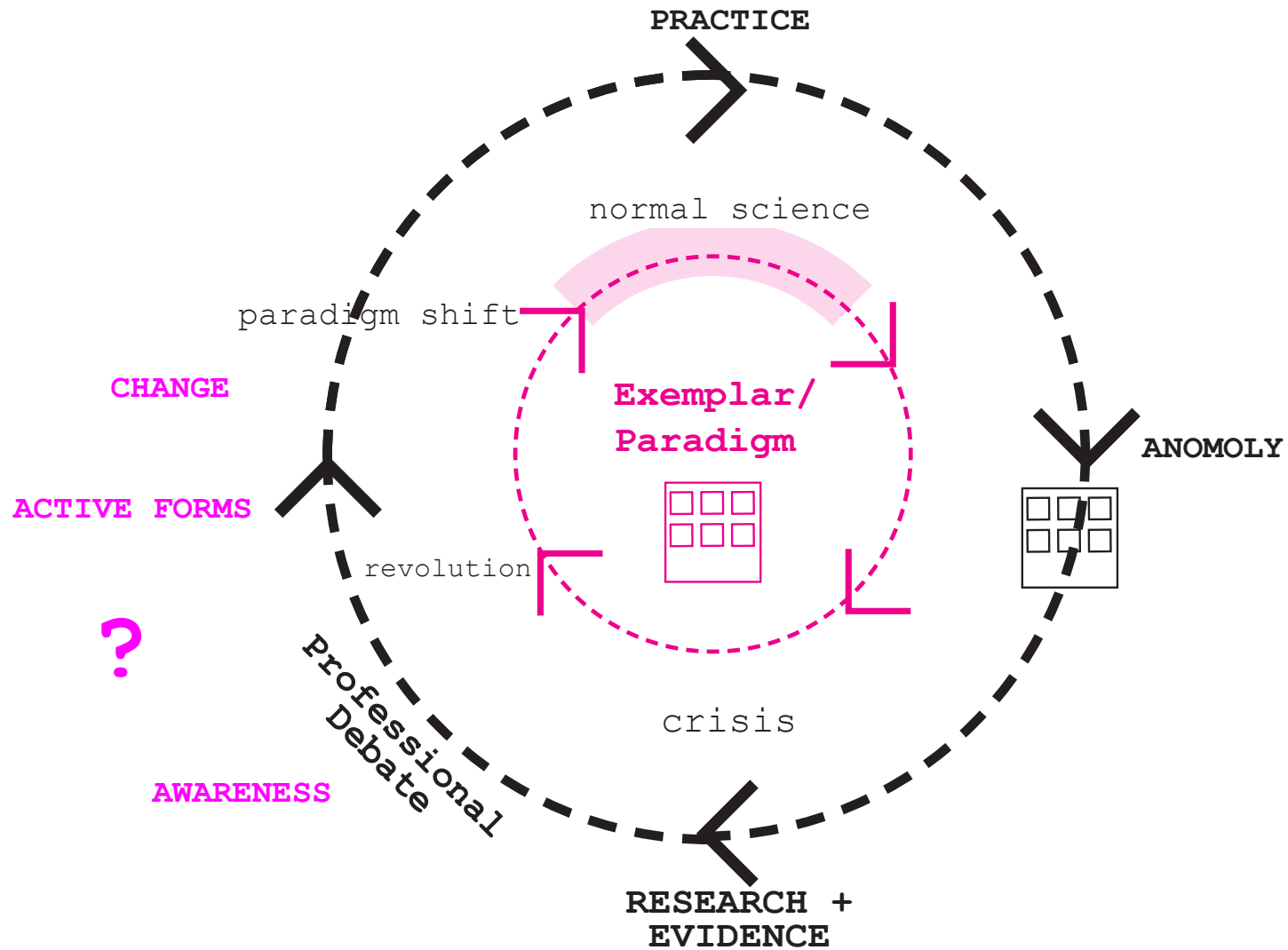
Contemporary Competition Judging Panel

GOOD PEOPLE / BAD SYSTEMS



## Future Architecture Front Instagram Posts

"VIBES-BASED AWARENESS"



Competence--> Judgment--> Responsibility--> Disciplinary Progress

## The Structure of Scientific Revolutions





Future Architecture Front

**PUBLIC PRESSURE**



Section of Architectural  
Workers/UAW

**WORKPLACE  
ORGANISING**



Just Transition Lobby

**INSTITUTIONAL  
GOVERNANCE**

**DIFFERENT ORGANISATIONS DO DIFFERENT WORK**



# 12 MYTHS ABOUT DIRECT ACTION

Direct action—that is, any kind of action that bypasses established political channels to accomplish objectives directly—has a long and rich heritage in North America, extending back to the Boston Tea Party and beyond. Despite this, there are many misunderstandings about it, in part due to the ways it has been misrepresented in the corporate media.

## DIRECT ACTION IS TERRORISM

Terrorism is calculated to intimidate and thus paralyze people. Direct action, on the other hand, is intended to inspire and thus motivate people by demonstrating the power individuals have to accomplish goals themselves. While terrorism is the domain of a specialized class that seeks to acquire power for itself alone, direct action demonstrates possibilities that others can make use of, empowering people to take control of their own lives. At most, a given direct action may obstruct the activities of a corporation or institution that activists perceive to be committing an injustice, but this is simply a form of civil disobedience, not terrorism.

## DIRECT ACTION IS VIOLENT

To say that it is violent to destroy the machinery of a slaughterhouse or to break windows belonging to a party that promotes war is to prioritize property over human and animal life. This objection subtly validates violence against living creatures by focusing all attention on property rights and away from more fundamental issues.

## DIRECT ACTION IS NOT POLITICAL EXPRESSION, BUT CRIMINAL ACTIVITY

Unfortunately, whether or not an action is illegal is a poor measure of whether or not it is just. The Jim Crow laws were, after all, laws. To object to an action on the grounds that it is illegal is to sidestep the more important question of whether or not it is ethical. To argue that we must always obey laws, even when we consider them to be unethical or to

enforce unethical conditions, is to suggest that the arbitrary pronouncements of the legal establishment possess a higher moral authority than our own consciences, and to demand complicity in the face of injustice. When laws protect injustice, illegal activity is no vice, and law-abiding docility is no virtue.

## DIRECT ACTION IS UNNECESSARY WHERE PEOPLE HAVE FREEDOM OF SPEECH

In a society dominated by an increasingly narrowly focused corporate media, it can be almost impossible to initiate a public dialogue on a subject unless something occurs that brings attention to it. Under such conditions, direct action can be a means of nurturing free speech, not squelching it. Likewise, when people who would otherwise oppose an injustice have accepted that it is inevitable, it is not enough simply to talk about it: one must demonstrate that it is possible to do something about it.

## DIRECT ACTION IS ALIENATING

On the contrary, many people who find traditional party politics alienating are inspired and motivated by direct action. Different people find different approaches fulfilling; a movement that is to be broad-based must include a wide range of options. Sometimes people who share the goals of those who practice direct action while objecting to their means spend all their energy decrying an action that has been carried out. In doing so, they snatch defeat from the jaws of victory: they would do better to seize the opportunity to focus all attention on the issues raised by the action.

## PEOPLE WHO PRACTICE DIRECT ACTION SHOULD WORK THROUGH THE ESTABLISHED POLITICAL CHANNELS INSTEAD

Many people who practice direct action also work within the system. A commitment to making use of every institutional means of solving problems does not necessarily preclude an equal commitment to picking up where such means leave off.

## DIRECT ACTION IS EXCLUSIVE

Some forms of direct action are not open to all, but this does not necessarily mean they are without worth. Everyone has different preferences and capabilities, and should be free to act according to them. The important question is how the differing approaches of individuals and groups that share the same long-term goals can be integrated in such a way that they complement each other.

## DIRECT ACTION IS COWARDLY

This accusation is almost always made by those who have the privilege of speaking and acting in public without fearing repercussions: that is to say, those who have power in this society, and those who obediently accept their power. Should the heroes of the French Resistance have demonstrated their courage and accountability by acting against the Nazi occupying army in the full light of day, thus dooming themselves to defeat? For that matter, in a nation increasingly terrorized by police and federal surveillance of just about everyone, is it any wonder that those who express dissent might want to protect their privacy while doing so?

## DIRECT ACTION IS PRACTICED ONLY BY COLLEGE STUDENTS/PRIVILEGED RICH KIDS/DESPERATE POOR PEOPLE/ETC

This allegation is almost always made without reference to concrete facts, as a smear. In fact, direct action is and long has been practiced in a variety of forms by people of all walks of life. The only possible exception to this would be members of the wealthiest and most powerful classes, who have no need to practice any kind of illegal or controversial action because, as if by coincidence, the established political channels are perfectly suited to their needs.

## DIRECT ACTION IS THE WORK OF AGENTS PROVOCATEURS

This is another speculation generally made from a distance, without concrete evidence. To allege that direct action is always the work of police agent provocateurs is disempowering: it rules out the possibil-

ity that activists could do such things themselves, overestimating the powers of police intelligence and reinforcing the illusion that the State is omnipotent. Likewise, it preemptively dismisses the value and reality of a diversity of tactics. When people feel entitled to make unfounded claims that every tactic of which they disapprove is a police provocation, this obstructs the very possibility of constructive dialogue about appropriate tactics.

## DIRECT ACTION IS DANGEROUS AND CAN HAVE NEGATIVE REPERCUSSIONS FOR OTHERS

Direct action can be dangerous in a repressive political climate, and it is important that those who practice it make every effort not to endanger others. This is not necessarily an objection to it, however—on the contrary, when it becomes dangerous to act outside established political channels, it becomes all the more important to do so. Authorities may use direct actions as excuses to terrorize innocents, as Hitler did when the Reichstag was set afire, but those in power are the ones who must answer for the injustices they commit in so doing, not those who oppose them. Likewise, though people who practice direct action may indeed run risks, in the face of an insufferable injustice it can be more dangerous and irresponsible to leave it uncontested.

## DIRECT ACTION NEVER ACCOMPLISHES ANYTHING

Every effective political movement throughout history, from the struggle for the eight hour workday to the fight for women's suffrage, has made use of some form of direct action. Direct action can complement other forms of political activity in a variety of ways. If nothing else, it highlights the necessity for institutional reforms, giving those who push for them more bargaining chips; but it can go beyond this supporting role to suggest the possibility of an entirely different organization of human life, in which power is distributed equally and all people have an equal and direct say in all matters that affect them.

# DIRECT ACTION



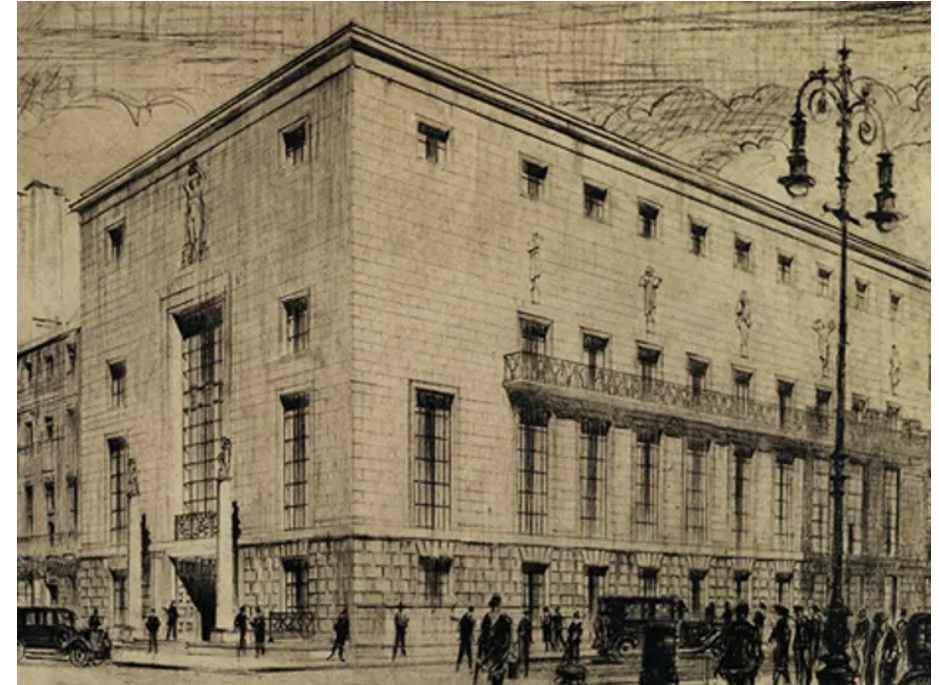
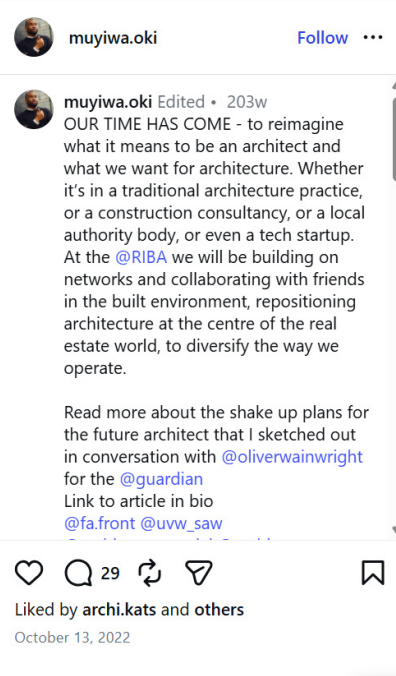


The RIBA

Interview

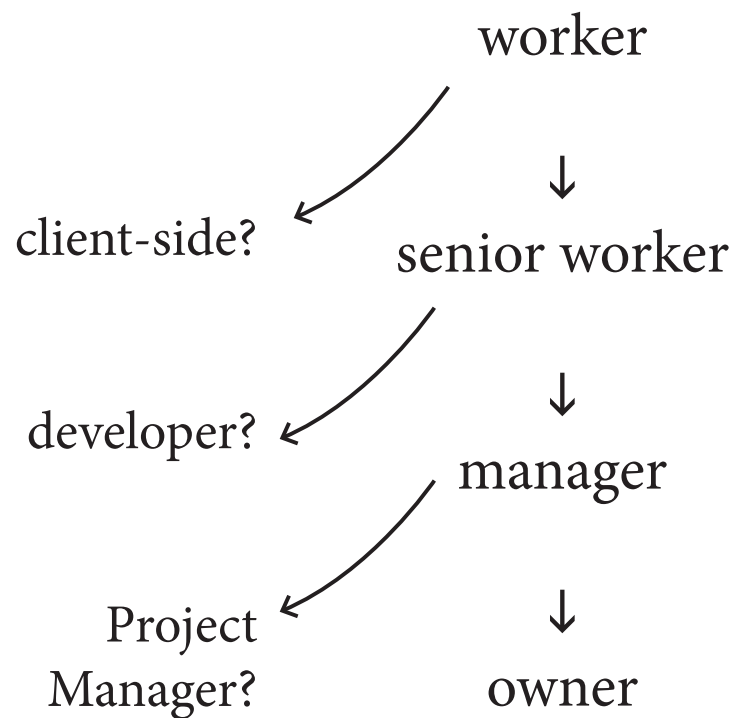
## 'Our time has come' - Muyiwa Oki, first black president of RIBA, reveals his shakeup plans

Oliver Wainwright



<https://www.riba.org/about-us/history-charter-and-byelaws/>

# WINNING THE PRESIDENT WASN'T ENOUGH



**Head** CEO is also held by a Partner. Additional expertise is brought to the Executive Board by the Heads of the Business Departments. **Practice**

**Founding Partners**

Jacques Herzog, Pierre de Meuron

**Senior Partners**

Christine Binswanger, Ascan Mergenthaler, Stefan Marbach, Jason Frantzen, Andreas Fries, Wim Walschap

**Partners**

Robert Hösl, Simon Demeuse, Santiago Espitia Berndt, Martin Knüsel, Olga Bolshanina

**Associate Partners**

Steffen Riegas, Christoph Röttinger, Tobias Winkelmann, Helen Ng, Julian Oggier, Tristan Zelic

**Strategic Board**

Jacques Herzog, Pierre de Meuron, Christine Binswanger, Andreas Fries, Ascan Mergenthaler, Stefan Marbach, Jason Frantzen, Wim Walschap

**Executive Board**

Olga Bolshanina, Mauro Di Domenico, Robert Hösl, Martin Knüsel, Stefan Marbach, Wim Walschap

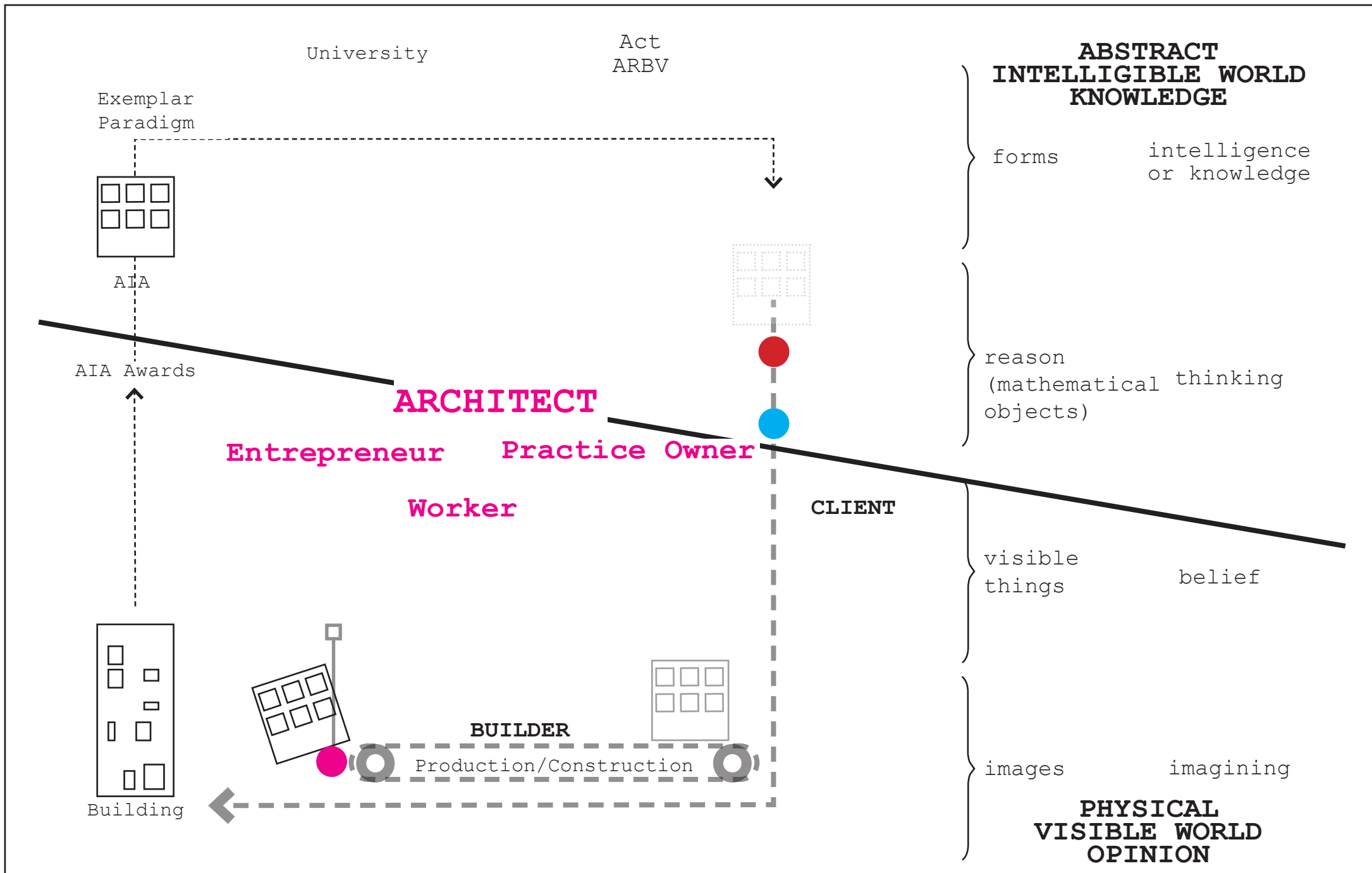
**CEO**

Wim Walschap

Herzog and de Meuron Structure Chart

ESCAPE UPWARDS





YOUR POSITION WILL CHANGE

## SUBJECT

~~What conditions am I working under?~~

~~What am I paid? What are my hours? What does my contract say?~~

~~What does the Award establish?~~

## INTERPRETER

How are fees established? Who sets the program? Where does responsibility sit? What rights already exist? Who possesses authority?

## CO-AUTHOR

Where is there actually capacity to change them?

MATCH THE MECHANISM TO THE PROBLEM



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Labor Union

We're the union of Architecture, Landscape & Interior workers & students, a division of Professionals Australia. We... more

[uaw.org.au/join](https://uaw.org.au/join)



Followed by ana\_jank, counterfactualcity + 3 more

Follow

Message



Start Here



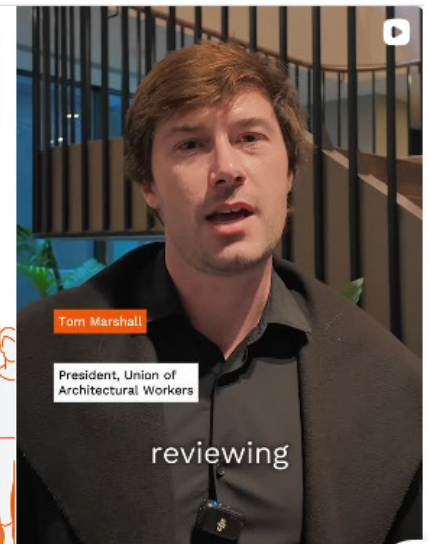
Rates



Award



Overtime



# UNION OF ARCHITECTURAL WORKERS